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CFRA Research
Fundamental Research Team
977 Seminole Trail, PMB 230
Charlottesville, VA 22901

Dear CFRA Fundamental Research Team,

CFRA's research is independent, and that word is the reason I am writing. For three years I worked as a solo quant developer with no firm behind me, which meant that every conclusion I reached about a market had to stand on its own evidence because nobody was going to defend it for me. That is the discipline I understand independent research to require, and the Equity Research Analyst role covering Industrials and Materials is where I want to apply it. I hold a BS in Computer Science with a 3.8 GPA and am currently pursuing an MS in Finance and Investment Management at Sacred Heart University, where valuation and the analysis of financial performance, the core of this role, are the center of my coursework.

My connection to Industrials and Materials comes from the commodity side. From 2022 to 2025 I taught myself MQL5 and NinjaScript and designed algorithmic trading tools for futures markets, the markets where the metals and energy that feed these sectors are priced every day. I built software that generates futures trading strategies, marketed it myself, and sold packages to roughly five clients, producing four-figure revenue. I also did contract work converting clients' manual trading strategies into automated algorithms, which meant extracting the exact logic behind each decision and encoding it so a machine could execute it without error. That work taught me to separate what a person believes about a market from what the data actually supports, and to write the difference down clearly. During my internship at Edward Jones I researched investment strategies for senior management and validated client records, my first experience producing analysis that someone else would act on.

I will be direct about the gap: I do not have two years in a published equity research seat, and I have not yet built DCF or comparable company models professionally. Those are the skills my graduate program is built to develop, and my record is one of closing gaps like that quickly. I taught myself two trading languages well enough to sell products built on them, published a mobile app called Agora on Google Play, and founded Rodriguez Pressure Washing LLC, which I have run end to end since 2023, including knocking on more than 1,000 doors to build it. Playing D1 soccer for a team ranked third nationally in the NAIA, and earning the Champions of Character Award, taught me to meet deadlines under pressure and to hold a standard whether or not anyone is watching. I am also bilingual in Spanish and proficient in Python, which I would use to speed up data work behind the research.

I am hardworking, I learn fast, and I take real pride in getting things right the first time. I would welcome the chance to talk about how I can contribute to CFRA's Industrials and Materials coverage. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Diego Rodriguez